

TABLE 6.1 : POPULATION OF SRI LANKA BY ETHNIC GROUPS IN CENSUS YEARS (IN THOUSANDS)

ETHNIC GROUP	1881	1891	1901	1911	1921	1946	1953	1963	1971	1981
All Ethnic Groups	2759.7	3007.8	3565.9	4106.4	4498.6	6657.3	8097.9	10582.0	12689.9	14 846.8
1. Sinhalese	1846.5	2041.2	2330.8	2715.5	3016.2	4620.5	5616.7	7512.9	<u>9131.2</u>	10 979.6
(a) Low country	-	-	1458.3	1716.9	1927.1	2902.5	3469.5	4470.3	5425.8	-
(b) Kandyan	-	-	872.5	998.6	1089.1	1718.0	2147.2	3042.6	3705.4	-
2. Tamils	687.2	723.9	951.7	1059.0	1120.0	1514.3	1858.8	2394.7	<u>2598.6</u>	2705.6
(a) Sri Lanka	-	-	-	528.0	517.3	733.7	884.7	1164.7	1423.9	1 286.7
(b) Indian	-	-	-	531.0	602.7	780.6	974.1	1230.0	1174.6	218.7
3. Moors	184.5	197.2	228.0	266.6	284.9	409.2	511.5	682.2	<u>855.7</u>	1 046.9
(a) Sri Lanka	-	-	-	233.9	251.9	373.6	464.0	626.8	828.3	-
(b) Indian	-	-	-	32.7	33.0	35.6	47.5	55.4	27.4	-
4. Burghers and Eurasians	17.9	21.2	23.5	26.7	29.4	41.9	45.9	45.9	<u>45.3</u>	39.4
5. Malays	8.9	10.1	11.9	13.0	13.4	22.5	25.5	33.4	<u>43.4</u>	47.0
6. Veddhas	2.2	1.2	4.0	5.3	4.5	2.3	.8	0.4	-	} 28.4
7. Europeans	4.8	4.7	6.3	7.6	8.1	5.4	6.5	-	-	
8. Others	7.5	8.3	9.7	12.7	22.0	41.1	32.2	<u>19.5</u>	<u>15.5</u>	

TABLE 6.2 : PERCENTAGE DISTRIBUTION OF ETHNIC GROUPS IN THE CENSUS YEARS